

Isadora Colmenares

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Summary

Accomplished Experience Designer and UX Engineer with nearly two decades of expertise orchestrating systemic visual hierarchy, complex content environments, and integrated digital-physical touchpoints. Proven leader in translating dense academic research, taxonomic data, and intricate human behavior analytics into intuitive, narrative-driven visual systems. Expert at managing cross-disciplinary team capacity, establishing unified design standards, and analyzing technical feasibility to ensure ambitious immersive concepts are successfully actualized.

Education

BFA | Graphic Design and Photography

Massachusetts College of Art and Design | 2007

- Graduated with honors and academic distinction.
- Awarded Bookbuilders of Boston scholarship.
- Awarded travel scholarship for design study in London.

Continuing Education | Sew Like a Pro

Fashion Institute of Technology | 2025

Semester Study Abroad | Photography, Printmaking, Italian

Studio Art Centers International (SACI), Florence, Italy | 2003

- Awarded SACI Photography Merit scholarship.

Post-Baccalaureate Coursework | Precalculus, Physiology and Cell Biology, Spanish

CUNY Queens College | 2012

Certifications

Certificates | Lean UX and Product Development

Nielsen Norman Group | 2024 – 2025

Certificates | User Experience Design and Front-End Web Development

General Assembly | 2018 – 2019

Certification and Training | Mac Technician and Software Educator

Apple | 2010 – 2012

Work Experience

■ Contract Experience Designer | American Museum of Natural History

May 2026 – Present | New York, NY

- Collaborated with curatorial leadership and internal museum staff to rebrand the Arachnology Lab / Scorpion Systematics Research Group and completely redesign and rearchitect the codebase for the lab's online presence.
- Designed and engineered a custom, highly searchable directory system to organize and display a vast repository of contact profiles, academic bios, and historic records for current and former lab members.
- Devised distinct sub-branding and interface guardrails to intentionally differentiate the lab's online workspace from the primary museum website, executing the institution's directive to establish an independent identity for the research group.
- Managed the layout styling, information mapping, and digital deployment of website components, content, and downloadable publication archives.

Skills

Experience & Spatial Design

- Experience Design
- Exhibition Design
- Spatial Storytelling
- Environmental Typography
- Identity Systems
- Information Architecture
- Wayfinding
- Design Systems
- Interactive Kiosks
- Dynamic Storytelling

Research & Methods

- Stakeholder Interviews
- Contextual Inquiry
- User Interviews
- Usability Testing
- UI Pattern Analysis
- Thematic Mapping
- User Journey Mapping
- User Persona Development
- Cross-Cultural Localization

Tools & Software

- Figma
- Miro
- FigJam
- Adobe Creative Cloud (Photoshop, Illustrator, After Effects, InDesign)
- VS Code

Technologies & Frameworks

- HTML5, CSS3/SCSS
- JavaScript
- Angular/TypeScript
- Bootstrap
- Adobe ExtendScript
- API Integration
- Chrome DevTools
- Git

Emerging Tech & AI

- Generative AI Assistants (UX Research Synthesis, Design Ideation, Code Optimization)
- Conversational Design Architecture
- AI-Driven Feature Logic

■ UX Manager | Korn Ferry

January 2026 – June 2026 | New York, NY

- Managed, prioritized, and supported a distributed team of 8 experience designers, overseeing career paths ranging from entry-level contractors to senior-level full-time practitioners.
- Unified conflicting points of view across a large, decentralized group of internal stakeholders, product owners, and executive leaders to secure a singular creative vision for high-visibility data layouts.
- Spearheaded user interface pattern analysis and cross-application dependency reviews to scale core design system components and support emerging generative AI product features, including AI agents for the Smart Invite to Apply module and AI Talent Search.
- Devised and implemented a structured project management framework within Jira using custom user story and task templates, optimizing design team resource capacity and securing end-to-end design traceability.
- Actively resolved overlapping interactive features across disconnected applications to align job mapping capabilities between separate Pay Analytics and Profile Manager tools.
- Directed user experience enhancements for high-visibility analytics dashboards, including the Pay Equity, Profile Comparison Matrix, Role Insights, and Cross-Application Talent reporting interfaces.

■ Contract Experience Designer | Verizon

October 2025 – January 2026 | New York, NY

- Contributed to the Verizon Design System through the end-to-end creation of modular Figma components engineered for advanced conversational prototyping.
- Designed interactive user pathways demonstrating responsive chat workflows between customers, automated AI assistance, and live customer support agents.
- Authored detailed functional specifications and interaction rules in close collaboration with development teams and design system leadership.
- Mentored design peers in interaction design best practices, ensuring a cohesive design standard across conversational touchpoints.

■ UX Design Lead | UBS

April 2024 – September 2025 | New York, NY

- Collaborated with cross-functional global leads to scale the core UBS design system and optimize design operations across enterprise logistics, recruiting, and talent ecosystems.
- Managed a distributed team of 9 experience designers, coordinating training and project alignment for interns, internal mobility candidates, intermediate practitioners, and senior/director-level designers.
- Leveraged Figma and Miro to architect, catalog, and document reusable design tokens, components, functional modules, and development specifications.
- Standardized agile processes, documentation templates, and collaborative workflows to unify design output across cross-regional teams in the AMER, EMEA, and APAC regions.

■ Principal UX Designer | Aon

December 2021 – April 2024 | New York, NY

- Led the experiential design, interactive strategy, and targeted usability validation of global B2B2C talent assessment applications, directly impacting millions of users worldwide.
- Designed and coded robust, highly flexible components using design variables, creating automated functionality that allowed systems to instantly adapt to bespoke client branding and sub-branding themes.
- Conducted expansive user research and stakeholder mapping workshops consisting of intensive user interviews, operational observation, and qualitative field evaluations to shape product blueprints.

Languages

- English
(Native)
- Spanish
(Professional Working Proficiency)
- Portuguese
(Limited Working Proficiency)
- French
(Elementary Proficiency)

Awards

Platinum Star Award

Aon

Recognition of colleagues who deliver exceptional project work and exemplify Aon United behavior in cross team support.

Inhouse Design Award

Graphic Design USA

Awarded for an event infographic visualizing data for Cambridge Innovation Institute's *Discovery on Target* international pharmaceutical conference.

SACI Photography Award

Studio Art Centers
International

Awarded for excellence in visual narrative and composition during Florence, Italy study abroad.

- Standardized more than 20 proprietary UX design, research, and documentation templates utilized by all active team members to dramatically accelerate project alignment, onboarding, and workflow efficiency.
- Linearly managed long-term user research initiatives regarding global skills-based pay models, directly informing Aon's Human Capital Solutions corporate strategy.

■ UX Engineering Lead | Aon

August 2019 – November 2021 | New York, NY

- Refactored a legacy situational judgment test into an accessible, mobile-first Single-Page Application using Angular and TypeScript, establishing an immersive simulation that assesses job candidates for role fit.
- Redesigned a multi-page testing center study materials microsite utilizing HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, directly driving \$620K+ in revenue and accelerating candidate information retrieval in preparation for at-home or on-site proctored assessments.
- Engineered complex data visualization content, mock email threads, and reference asset blocks for the study microsite, optimizing how candidates evaluated data while participating in live phone calls with role-play assessors.
- Managed the front-end technical integration of assessment applications directly into major enterprise applicant tracking platforms, serving as the core technical bridge between design and engineering.
- Acted as the Functional Product Lead for proprietary assessment solutions, owning feature prioritization, mapping user vision with business stakeholders, and managing engineering backlogs.

■ Part-Time Instructional Assistant | General Assembly

February 2019 – January 2021 | New York, NY

- Translated complex user experience design methodologies and technical core concepts (HTML, CSS, JavaScript) into actionable learning frameworks for aspiring practitioners.

■ Senior Designer | Cambridge Innovation Institute

February 2016 – August 2019 | Boston, MA

- Orchestrated the comprehensive visual and environmental design ecosystem for over 60 annual large-scale international conferences, spanning life sciences, biotech, energy storage, pharmaceutical research, and emerging technologies.
- Designed holistic cross-channel marketing campaigns comprising print advertisements, posters, emails, digital and print brochures of conference abstracts, and web advertisements to drive pre-event engagement.
- Translated event branding into environmental design artifacts for the in-person conference experience, designing large-scale on-site entryway arches, wayfinding signage, and backdrops for video interviews and social media selfies.
- Sketched, wireframed, and styled responsive event website prototypes to capture attendee registrations and speaker abstracts.
- Programmed automated workflow scripts using Adobe ExtendScript and InDesign APIs to seamlessly import live event speaker database streams directly into complex print layouts.

■ Graphic Designer | National Institute for Amazonian Research (INPA)

February 2013 – August 2016 | Manaus, Brazil

- Developed rapid website prototypes, multi-screen email campaigns, visual brand identities, and comprehensive environmental graphics and staging layouts for an international ornithology congress attracting global museum curators, students, and academic professionals.
- Executed the complete brand identity design and visual style guides for three departments: Ornithology, Management of Protected Areas in the Amazon, and Botany/Biological Sciences.
- Hand-rendered detailed scientific illustrations, taxonomy figures, and complex biogeographical maps to support the published work of ecology and botany graduate students.

■ User Experience Designer and Front End Developer | Freelance

June 2003 – February 2016 | International

- Coded responsive websites, designed data visualization, and produced marketing collateral and motion design for a global client base, academic publications, and scientific research institutes.

■ Design Instructor and Computer Technician | Apple

October 2008 – July 2012 | New York, NY

- Led technical user workshops and diagnostic troubleshooting initiatives, translating complex hardware and software ecosystems into clear, accessible user workflows.

■ Art Designer | Time Inc.

December 2007 – September 2008 | New York, NY

- Sourced, curated, and formatted editorial imagery and visual content assets for Health.com.

■ Motion Designer | Cramer Productions

May 2007 – October 2007 | Boston, MA

- Designed high-impact multi-screen motion graphics, dynamic video content, and environmental background animations for large-scale corporate theater productions, keynotes, and live conferences.

■ Graphic Designer | Ronn Campisi Design

June 2006 – May 2007 | Boston, MA

- Designed complex grid systems and typographic hierarchies for a diverse range of prominent academic, medical, and economic magazines, newsletters, and advertorial publications.

■ Part-Time Software Instructor | Adobe

September 2004 – May 2007 | Boston, MA

- Led technical software workshops and provided personalized instruction to students mastering advanced vector illustration, layout, image manipulation, and digital publishing tools.

Volunteering

■ Field Research Volunteer

Association of Friends of the Manatee (AMPA) and The Pink Dolphin Project | Manaus, Brazil

- Documented behavioral patterns of river dolphin populations in the Amazon River and assisted wildlife veterinarians by recording manatee anatomical measurements.
- Designed detailed biogeographical maps and custom scientific illustrations for ecology and botany graduate students.

■ Portfolio Review Organizer

Behance Manaus | Manaus, Brazil

- Coordinated and curated regional portfolio review and networking event in collaboration with Adobe and Behance to foster connection with local artists and design professionals.

■ Chair of Gardening Committee, Member of Energy Conservation Committee

The Burton Co-op Board of Directors | Bronx, NY

- Implemented organic gardening and native planting guidelines to attract natural pollinators.
- Researched solutions for reducing resource consumption in 150+ unit residential building.

■ English Tutor

Action Inc. | Gloucester, MA

- Tutored in English for Portuguese speakers participating in Action's adult education program.

■ Animal Care Provider

Animal Care Centers of NYC | New York, NY

- Cared for cats in adoptions, nursery, sick ward, and intake.